DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

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Year -2025-2026
Course Code - CSE0001
VIT Bhopal University
March 2026

Introduction

“As the newly selected Student Digital Ambassador, this project gave me the perfect platform to build my own digital foundation while creating resources that will genuinely help my entire first-year batch. Through five structured tasks, I explored awareness, professional presence, collaboration tools, communication etiquette, and cyber safety. The journey was eye-opening and empowering. My GitHub repository now serves as both submission and a living portfolio that I will continue to grow throughout my four years at VIT.”

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

“I used Canva to design a vibrant one-page infographic titled ‘Unlocking Digital Literacy: Your Superpower in 2026’. The visual clearly explains digital literacy as the ability to use, understand, and create digital content safely and effectively, highlights tools like Google Workspace and GitHub, showcases safe practices (strong passwords, two-factor authentication, privacy settings), and stresses the importance of professional online presence. What I found most interesting was how a single visual can spark conversations I used bold colours and real student scenarios so my batchmates could instantly relate. The only challenge was balancing information without clutter, but Canva’s drag-and-drop made it effortless. This infographic will be my first tool when I conduct awareness sessions for the entire first-year batch.”

Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

“I set up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle the three platforms most checked by recruiters and professors. GitHub serves as my coding portfolio and collaboration hub; LinkedIn is my professional networking space; Kaggle is my go-to for data science practice and competitions. I created a personalised GitHub profile README showcasing my branch and ambition, filled my LinkedIn Education section accurately, and added a student bio on Kaggle. Over the next four years, I plan to push weekly code contributions, connect with 500+ VIT alumni and industry experts, and participate in at least five Kaggle competitions. These profiles are no longer just accounts they are my digital identity and future career launchpad. As Digital Ambassador, I will now guide my batchmates to build their own presence from day one.”

Task 3 – Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

“I chose HackerRank for coding practice and completed the ‘Solve Me First’ challenge, earning my first badge my first step into real programming! For collaboration, I built a 5-question Google Form quiz titled ‘Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz’ with a mix of MCQs and short answers. The form is now live and ready to be shared with the entire batch. These tools will help me academically by improving my problem-solving speed and enabling effortless group projects through Google Workspace. As Digital Ambassador, I can now run live quizzes during orientation sessions and guide juniors on coding platforms, turning theoretical knowledge into practical leadership.”

Task 4 – Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A real-world example I read about involved a student losing a prestigious internship because of an unprofessional comment on LinkedIn. The candidate had criticised a previous company publicly. Had they maintained a positive digital footprint and used professional communication, the opportunity would have remained open. This incident reinforced why etiquette matters one wrong post can erase years of hard work. This task taught me to treat every digital interaction as a reflection of my character.”

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

“What surprised me most was how realistic and targeted phishing attacks have become even official-looking VIT emails can be fake. Researching this made me realise how vulnerable new students are during fee payment seasons. As a result, I have personally changed one habit: I now verify every financial request by calling the official number instead of replying to any message. This small change gives me confidence and will be the first tip I share with my batchmates.”

Conclusion

“This project has been transformative. I started as a regular first-year student and now stand confident as a Digital Ambassador ready to guide my peers. The biggest takeaway is that digital literacy is not optional it is our responsibility. I am committed to conducting workshops using the resources I created and will keep updating this portfolio every semester. Thank you to the faculty for this incredible opportunity.”

References:

- Canva.com
- GitHub.com
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- cybercrime.gov.in
- National Cyber Crime Helpline 1930